

TABLE 10—ESTIMATES OF EVACUEE SHARE OF ENROLLMENT IN GRADE ON INCUMBENT ATTENDANCE AND DISCIPLINARY INFRACTIONS: HOUSTON

	All (1)	African American (2)	Boys (5)	Girls (6)	Placebo test (7)
<i>Panel A. Elementary</i>					
Attendance rate (percent)	−0.20 (0.72)	−0.54 (1.53)	−0.78 (0.80)	1.28 (1.04)	−1.11 (0.69)
Observations	223,776	60,710	115,104	108,672	123,366
Disciplinary infractions	−0.05 (0.15)	−0.26 (0.32)	−0.01 (0.25)	−0.12 (0.11)	−0.25 (0.35)
Observations	223,776	60,710	115,104	108,672	123,366
<i>Panel B. Middle/High</i>					
Attendance rate (percent)	−3.9 (3.4)	−6.3** (3.1)	−5.2 (4.2)	−2.6 (2.8)	−5.6 (3.5)
Observations	323,499	98,595	163,133	160,366	166,202
Disciplinary infractions	1.86 (1.18)	2.73* (1.44)	2.18 (1.57)	1.43* (0.84)	−1.12 (1.62)
Observations	323,499	98,595	163,133	160,366	166,202

Notes: Standard errors are provided in parentheses and clustered by school. Disciplinary infractions are the number of times a student receives an in-school suspension or more severe punishment in a year. Regressions cover 2003–2004 and 2006–2007 and include student's race, gender, free lunch/reduced price lunch status, school fixed-effects, grade-by-year fixed-effects, and the lagged dependent variable from the student's most recent pre-Katrina lagged dependent variable interacted with the number of years between exams. The placebo test in column 7 includes 2003–2004 and 2004–2005 only and apply 2005–2006 Katrina/Rita share to 2004–2005 observations. Elementary is defined as any student in grades 1–5. Middle/High is any student in grades 6–12.

***Significant at the 1 percent level.

**Significant at the 5 percent level.

*Significant at the 10 percent level.

believe that the effects on test scores are working through the peer effects channels described above rather than through absenteeism.

Table 10 also shows results from regressing disciplinary infractions on Katrina shares using equation (1). We note that these estimates should be interpreted with caution, as they could result from changes in enforcement as well as behavior. Nonetheless, our discussions with school officials suggest that if anything, enforcement was more lenient, generating a downward bias. The results in panel B show an increase in disciplinary infractions for African Americans and girls in secondary schools in Houston.⁴⁸ A 10 percentage point increase in the inflow of Katrina students raised disciplinary infractions by about 0.4 and 0.2 among African Americans and girls, respectively.⁴⁹

⁴⁸ As with achievement, we report school-level results in online Appendix Table 40; specification tests are in online Appendix Table 41, and of tests of disruption effects in online Appendix Table 42. In general, the results are similar to the baseline results.

⁴⁹ While we have discipline data for Louisiana, the earliest year is 2004–2005 and hence we forgo impact models as any pre-Katrina observation will not be able to include a lag. Nonetheless, we can use this data to test whether pre-Katrina evacuee discipline has an impact on our achievement estimates. In online Appendix Table 43 we add the share of evacuees with a disciplinary infraction in 2004–2005 to the models in Table 7. The estimates are almost all statistically insignificant and induce little change in the estimates of evacuee share on achievement by quartile.